



Whodunit?

Writing Murder
Mysteries with LLMs

James Heller | Apartment 304

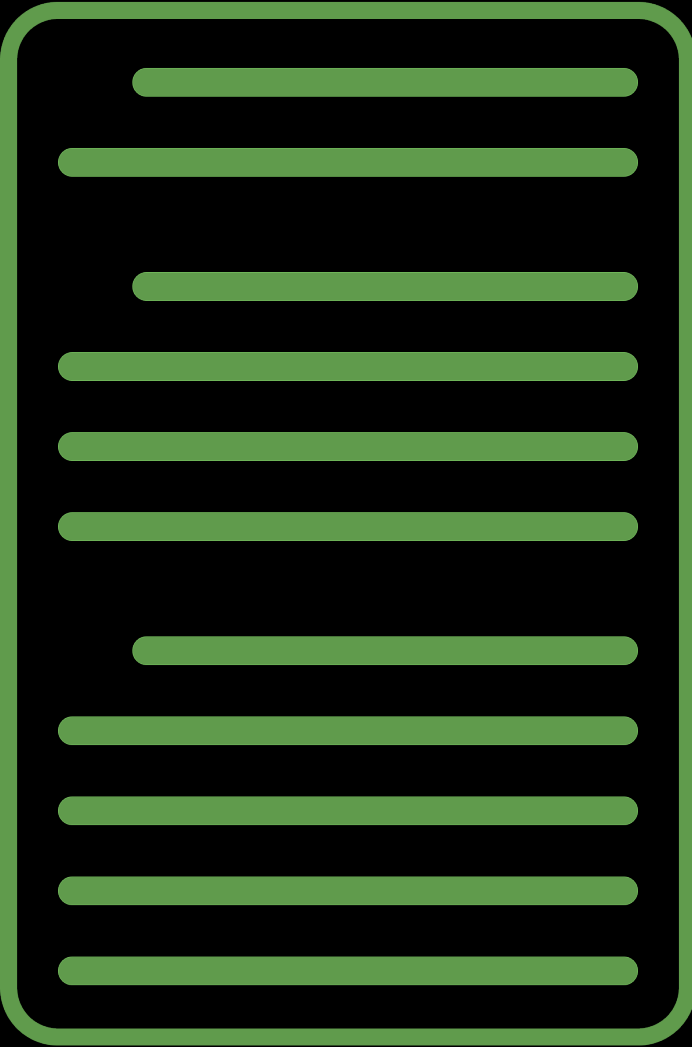


Goals

- Develop a mental model for working with LLMs
- Test a few top-tier LLMs and their Go libraries
- Convince LLMs to write mysteries

What's in a Mystery?

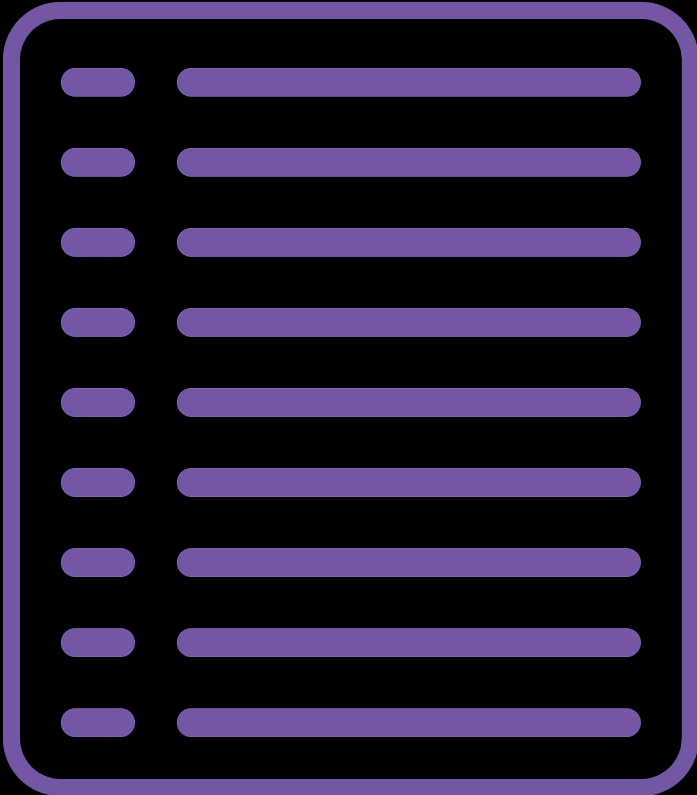
Scene



Setting



Clues



Solution



Denouement



Calling LLMs

Fundamentals

```
type TextGenerator interface {
    Generate(in Input) (Response, error)
}

type Input struct {
    SystemPrompt string `json:"systemPrompt,omitempty"`
    Prompt        Prompt  `json:"prompt,omitempty"`
    History       []Prompt `json:"history,omitempty"`
}

type Prompt struct {
    Role string `json:"role,omitempty"` // user, model
    Text string `json:"text,omitempty"`
}

type Response struct {
    Text string `json:"text,omitempty"`
}
```


Building Better Mysteries

All in One

You are a mystery writer for the game “Whodunit?”. Please write a mystery. The mystery needs a **scene** (introductory information), a **setting**, **clues** hidden at locations or with characters, a **solution** (questions the player needs to answer), and a **denouement** to summarize the events.

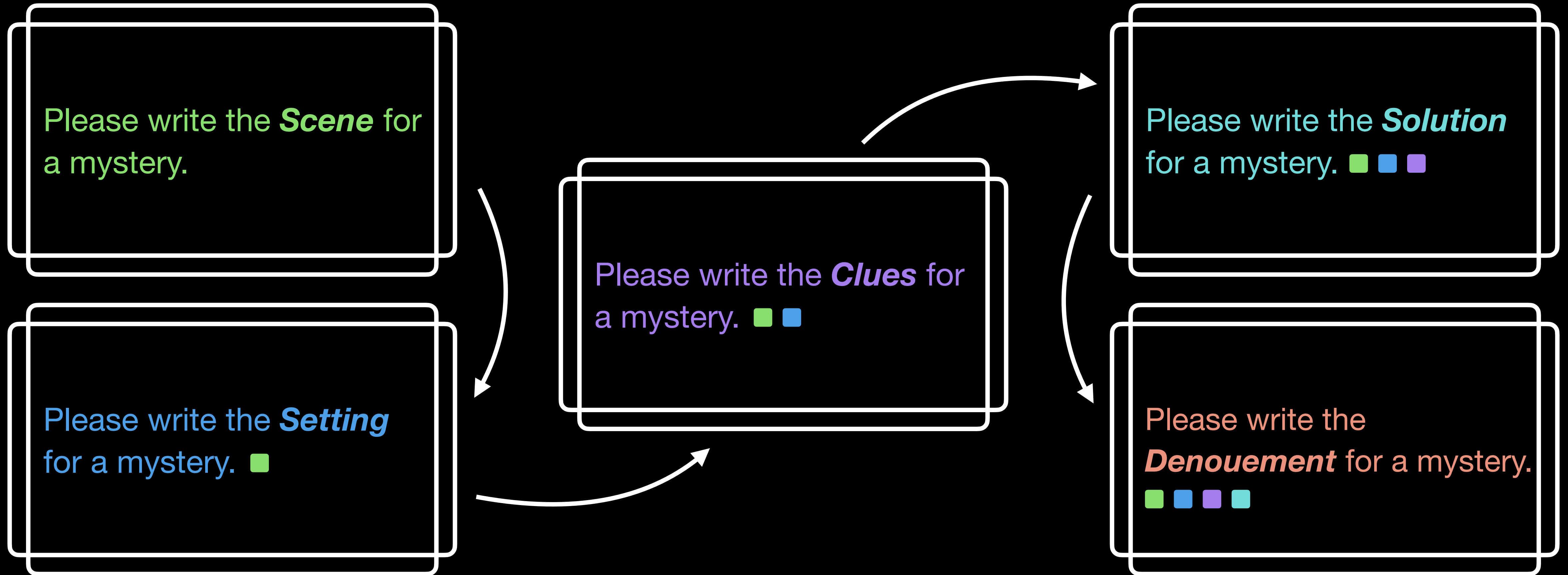
Write your output with the following structure.

```
<model>
{
  "scene": "Silence fell on a dark and stormy night in Wintertree Hall. <...>",
  "clues": [
    {
      "location": "Oyster Bar",
      "clue": "<...>"
    },
    {
      "characterRole": "conductor",
      "clue": "<...>"
    },
  ],
  "solution": {
    "Who is the murderer?": "<...>",
    "What was the motive?": "<...>",
    "What was the murder weapon?": "<...>"
  },
  "denouement": "<...>"
}
</model>
```

Break it Down

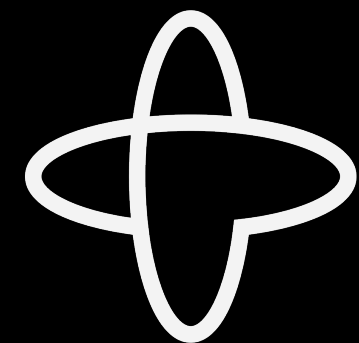
Building Better Mysteries

Break it Down



Building Better Mysteries

Break it Down

 Temporal

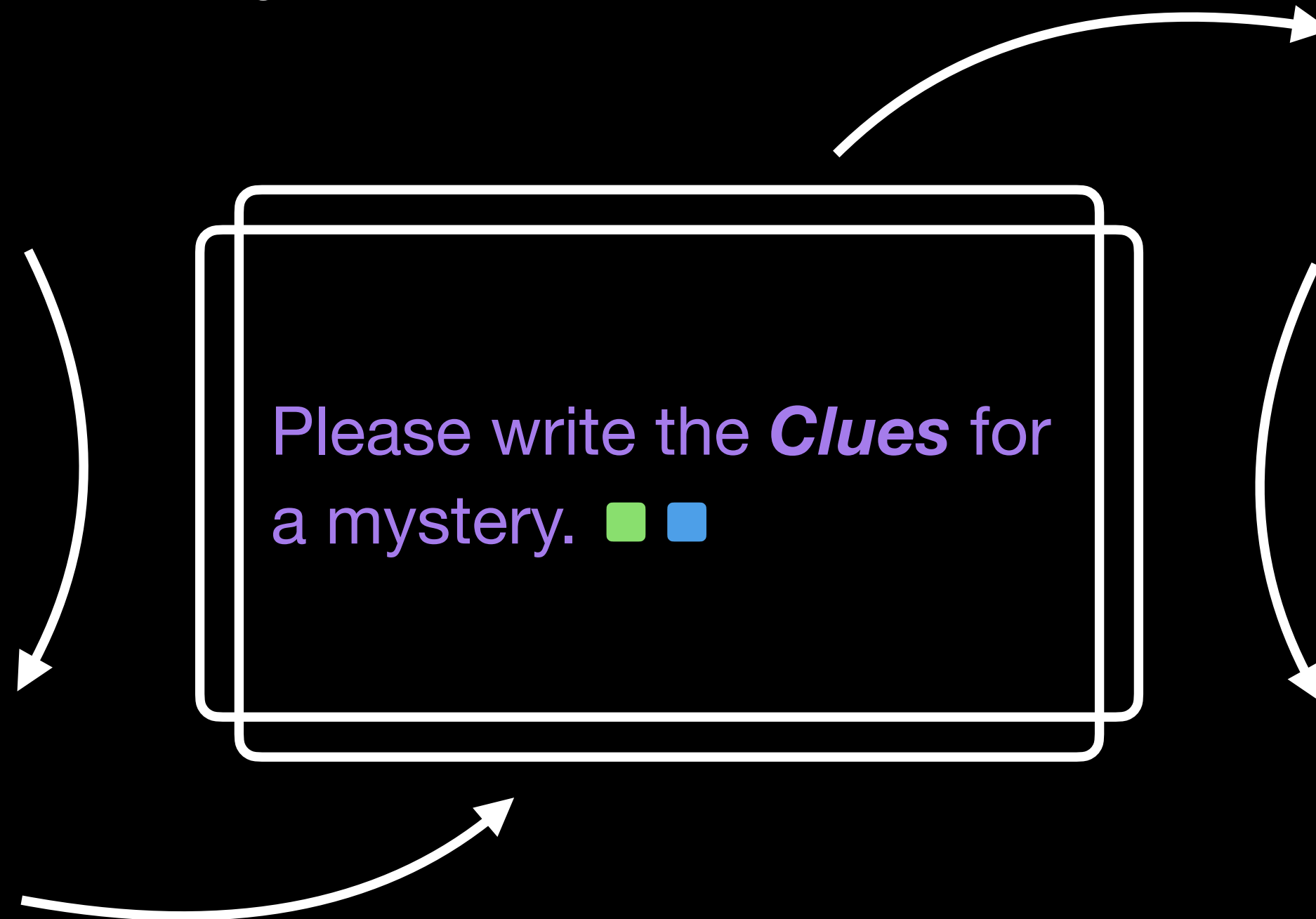
Please write the **Scene** for a mystery.

Please write the **Setting** for a mystery. ■

Please write the **Clues** for a mystery. ■ ■

Please write the **Solution** for a mystery. ■ ■ ■

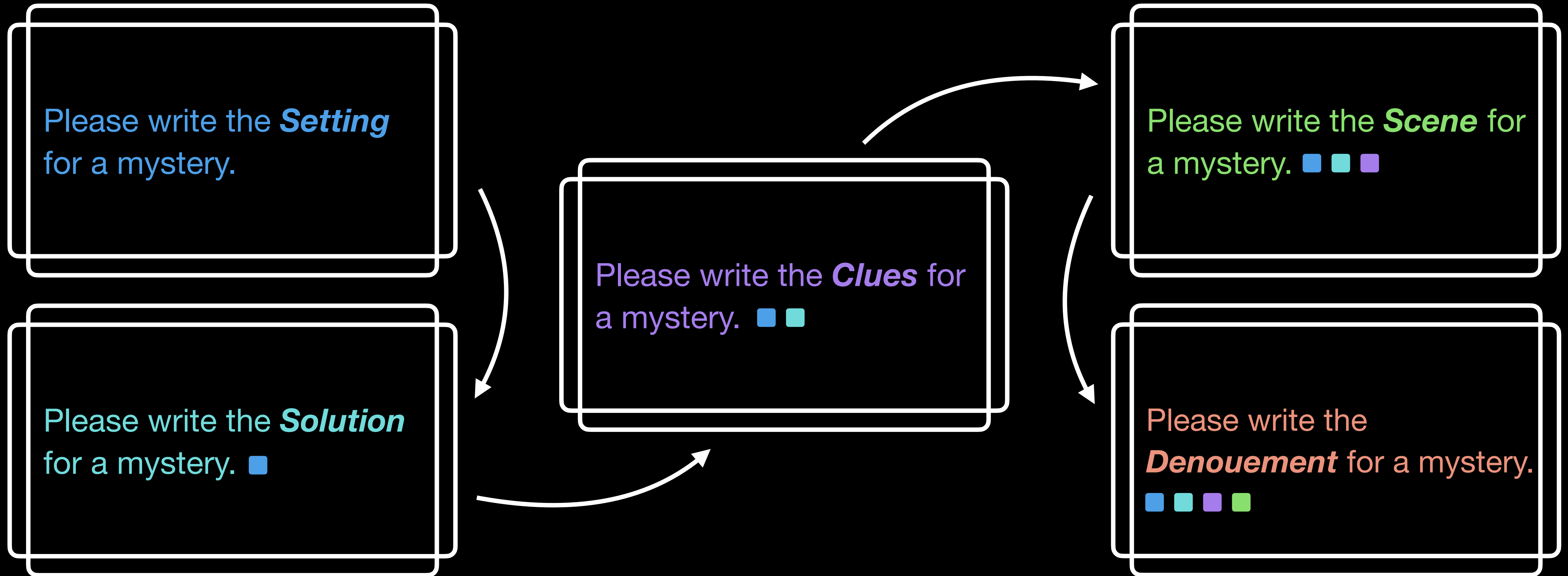
Please write the **Denouement** for a mystery. ■ ■ ■ ■



Order Matters

Building Better Mysteries

Order Matters



"Please Try Again"

Try Again, Please

```
func EditResponse(originalPrompt, originalInput, originalOutput string) (string, error) {
    systemPrompt := ``
        Read the original prompt, input, and output.
        Audit the output. Update it so that it follows all the instructions in the original prompt.
        Make the fewest changes needed.``

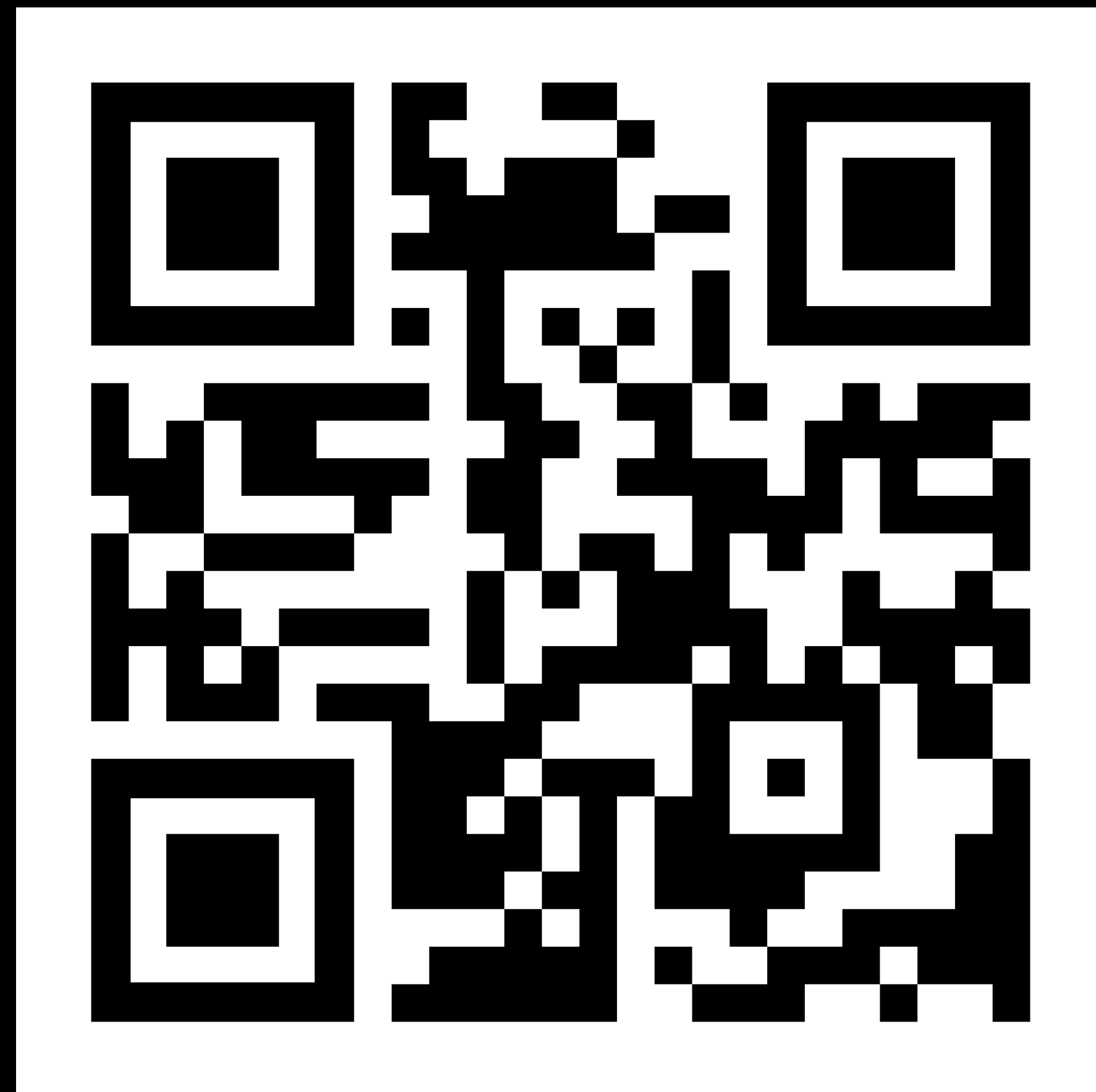
    editorPrompt := ``
        Original Prompt:
        %s
        Original Input:
        %s
        Original Output:
        %s``

    editorPrompt = fmt.Sprintf(editorPrompt, originalPrompt, originalInput, originalOutput)

    in := Input{
        SystemPrompt: systemPrompt,
        Prompt: Prompt{ Role: "user", Prompt: editorPrompt },
    }

    resp, err := Generate(in Input)
    // check error
}
```

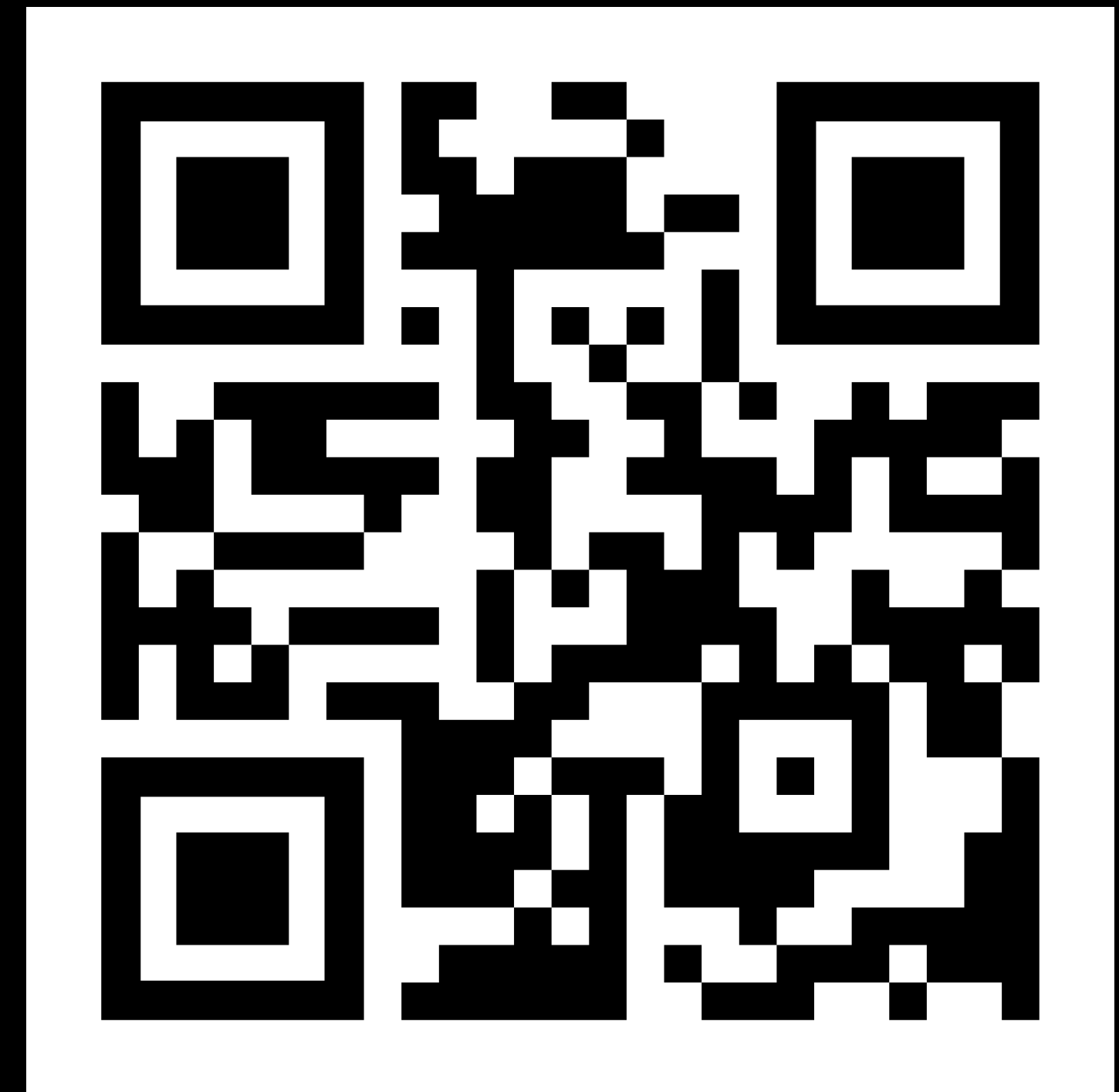
<https://whodunit.rip>



whodunit.rip

- Go — Server-side rendered web app
- Templ — HTML templates
- HTMX — On-page interactivity
- Temporal — Turn based game engine

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APARTMENT 304
BUILDING RELIABLE SOFTWARE

